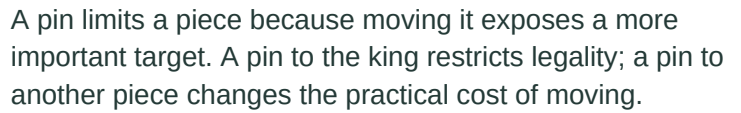


Pins and pressure

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

Previous move: 20.Kg2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

20...Rh2+ 21. Kf1 Rh1+ 22. Ng1 Rxcg1+ 23. Kxcg1 Rh1#

20...Rh2+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **21.Kf1.**

21...Rh1+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **22.Ng1.**

22...Rxb1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the knight on g1. Recorded reply: **23.Kxb1**.

23...Rh1# Mate: rook on h1 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on h1. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.